

LEARNORA / PRACTICAL DIGITAL SKILLS

Facebook & Instagram Ads Basics

A beginner's field guide to planning, launching and improving Meta ads in India

YOUR OUTCOME

Build one clear campaign brief, launch with a measured test, and turn results into a sensible next decision. Includes templates, sample copy, a diagnostic worksheet and a 30-day plan.

2026 EDITION • LEARNORA

How to use this book

A short path from business goal to campaign decision.

Meta ads can place a business in front of people on Facebook and Instagram. The setup screen is only one part of the job. You also need an offer people understand, a destination that works, a way to handle enquiries, and a budget you can afford to test.

Read in three passes

- Plan: pages 4–8. Fill the campaign brief before opening Ads Manager.
- Build: pages 9–14. Follow the launch sequence and adapt the examples.
- Improve: pages 15–21. Use the diagnostic and 30-day system to make one change at a time.

REALITY CHECK

Ad delivery, leads and purchases are never guaranteed. A low cost per message can still be unprofitable if the enquiries are irrelevant. The examples in this book are labelled illustrative and are not benchmarks.

Interface labels, eligibility, placements and billing options can change. Check the live settings in your account before publishing. This edition was researched in September 2026.

FIELD GUIDE / 01

Contents

A working reference, designed to be used beside Ads Manager.

- 04 The campaign map
- 05 Choose your real goal
- 06 Make an offer worth noticing
- 07 Build a measurement plan
- 08 Prepare the account
- 09 Audience and placements
- 10 Budget and test design
- 11 Create the campaign
- 12 The creative system
- 13 Copy and message scripts
- 14 Instant forms and WhatsApp
- 15 Launch quality check
- 16 Read the numbers
- 17 Diagnose weak results
- 18 Improve without guessing
- 19 Illustrative campaign walkthrough
- 20 Worksheets and swipe files
- 21 30-day action plan
- 22 Quick reference and sources
- 23 Closing page

FIELD GUIDE / 02

The campaign map

Understand where each decision lives.

In Meta Ads Manager, a campaign has three levels. The exact controls shown depend on the objective, account and current interface.

LEVEL	DECISION	CHECK BEFORE PUBLISH
Campaign	Business objective and, where available, campaign-level budget	Does the objective match the desired action?
Ad set	Conversion location, performance goal, audience, placements, schedule and possibly budget	Can the destination receive and track enquiries?
Ad	Identity, creative, copy, CTA and destination	Is the preview legible and the link or chat working?

One decision chain

GOAL → ACTION → DESTINATION → SIGNAL

Example: qualified class enquiries → submit an instant form → form with location and preferred time → count qualified follow-ups, not only form submissions.

A boosted post is an ad, but Ads Manager provides broader setup and reporting controls. Use Ads Manager when you need a deliberate test and a clear reporting trail.

FIELD GUIDE / 03

Choose your real goal

Select the objective by the action you want to measure.

BUSINESS NEED	POSSIBLE OBJECTIVE	FIRST THING TO VERIFY
Introduce a new local store	Awareness	Reach in the actual service area
Send people to an informative page	Traffic	Landing page loads and explains the offer
Get comments, video views or chats	Engagement	Chosen performance goal and message destination
Collect enquiries	Leads	Form or chat quality and follow-up capacity
Sell through a working website	Sales	Purchase event and checkout function
Promote an app	App promotion	App measurement is configured

These are Meta's six current objective families. Available conversion locations and performance goals differ within them. Choose the closest available option to the real outcome; never assume that a traffic objective will optimise for purchases.

DECISION RULE

If the business cannot follow up leads promptly, repair that process before paying for more leads. If the website checkout is broken, fix it before optimising for purchases.

FIELD GUIDE / 04

Make an offer worth noticing

Strong ads start with a specific, honest proposition.

The offer card

PROMPT	FILL THIS IN
Who exactly benefits?	A clear customer situation, without asserting private traits
What is offered?	Product or service, format, location and availability
What makes it credible?	Demonstration, process, transparent terms or verifiable proof
What should they do?	Message, submit form, visit page or purchase
What happens next?	Response time, next step and any relevant price terms

Illustrative example: “Offline beginner sewing classes in Vesu, Surat. Explore the timetable and course details; enquire for the next batch.” It names the audience’s decision and the next step without promising an outcome.

Before making an ad

- Confirm the price or pricing process, service area and stock or batch availability.
- Make the destination answer the same question as the ad.
- Prepare someone to reply to enquiries and record whether they are qualified.

FIELD GUIDE / 05

Build a measurement plan

Define success before you see a dashboard.

STEP	QUESTION	RECORD
Outcome	What action matters to the business?	Enquiry, appointment, order or another event
Quality	What makes the action useful?	Service area, budget, timing, intent
Value	What can this action reasonably support?	Margin or capacity; avoid invented estimates
Cost	What amount can the business risk testing?	Total test cap and review date

The measurement ladder

Impression → link click or message start → enquiry → qualified enquiry → sale. A campaign can look healthy at one rung and weak at the next. Record offline outcomes in a simple sheet when Ads Manager cannot see them.

LEAD LOG FIELDS

Date | campaign/ad | name or ID | contact status | service area | need | qualified? | appointment? | sale? | reason lost. Store personal data securely, limit access and follow current privacy requirements.

For website sales, verify the relevant Meta Pixel or Conversions API event in Events Manager and test the complete checkout. Avoid treating a reported purchase count as audited revenue.

FIELD GUIDE / 06

Prepare the account

Remove operational blockers before spending.

- Confirm you have appropriate access to the Facebook Page, Instagram account and ad account. Add a payment method offered to your account and verify billing details.
- Connect the intended Page and Instagram identity. For click-to-WhatsApp ads, connect the correct business number and test an incoming message.
- Set the right account time zone and currency when creating the ad account; changes later can be disruptive.
- Prepare the landing page, form or chat flow. Check it on a phone with a normal data connection.
- For website campaigns, configure measurement and check events; for forms, provide a working privacy policy link.

INDIA-FIRST NOTE

Keep invoices and billing records. Tax treatment and input credit depend on your circumstances and current rules; confirm the applicable GST position with official guidance or a qualified tax professional. Do not assume every payment method is available in every account.

Audience and placements

Start with the geography and language of a real customer.

Audience worksheet

SETTING	PRACTICAL QUESTION
Location	Can you serve the person there? A local shop should check city/radius carefully.
Age	Does the product have a genuine age restriction or audience fit?
Language	Is the creative understandable to the intended audience? Test Gujarati, Hindi or English based on the offer.
Signals	Are any interests or custom audiences truly useful and permitted?
Exclusions	Should existing customers be excluded from acquisition, if available and appropriate?

Use placements suited to the objective and creative. Advantage+ placements can distribute across eligible placements; inspect previews and results by placement. If you restrict to Facebook or Instagram, write down why and compare fairly. Vertical creative should be checked for cropping and safe areas in Stories and Reels.

AVOID TINY AUDIENCE LOGIC

Narrowing location, age and interests simultaneously can reduce delivery. Begin with the constraints the business truly needs; let the first test reveal where quality comes from.

FIELD GUIDE / 08

Budget and test design

Protect the learning budget and make the test interpretable.

Set a total amount you can afford to lose while learning. Decide the test duration and the stop date in advance. Daily budgets are pacing targets, not a promise that each calendar day will spend the exact amount; review the account's billing guidance and use available spending controls.

A clean beginner test

- One outcome and one destination per test.
- One core audience or a small number of clearly different audiences.
- Two or three distinct creative angles: demonstration, common question, and offer explanation.
- A single review sheet recording spend, results, quality and what you changed.

Illustrative planning arithmetic, not a Meta requirement: ₹300 per day for 7 days implies a planned ₹2,100 test. Actual pacing and billed totals may differ; check the live account and set controls accordingly.

BUDGET DECISION

If the affordable test cannot produce enough observations to learn, narrow the question. For example, test which message angle starts more relevant conversations before trying to estimate cost per purchase.

FIELD GUIDE / 09

Create the campaign

A reliable sequence for your first draft.

1 / Create

Open Ads Manager, select Create, choose the objective tied to your desired action and name the campaign clearly.

2 / Configure

At ad set level, choose the destination and performance goal, location, audience, schedule, placements and budget as offered.

3 / Compose

Select the Page/Instagram identity. Add media, primary text, headline if available, CTA and the correct destination.

4 / Verify

Use the preview for each important placement; test the link, form or WhatsApp chat on a phone.

5 / Publish

Review any special ad category requirements and policy checks, then publish. Monitor delivery status and diagnostics.

NAMING TEMPLATE

[Brand] | [Outcome] | [Location] | [Offer] | [Month] · Example: Learnora | Leads | India | Ebook enquiry | Sep 2026

The creative system

Show something the customer can judge in seconds.

ANGLE	WHAT TO SHOW	WHEN IT HELPS
Demonstration	Product in use or service process	The offer is visual or unfamiliar
Answer a question	A real objection with a specific response	People ask the same question repeatedly
Offer clarity	What is included, for whom, and next step	The buying decision needs detail

A simple 15-second video outline

Opening: name the situation or show the result. Middle: demonstrate one concrete benefit or process. Close: state the offer and one action. Add readable on-screen text and check the sound-off version. This is a creative template, not a claim about ideal video length.

Creative review checklist

- First frame makes sense without a caption.
- The ad and destination make the same promise.
- Text remains visible in feed, Stories and Reels previews.
- No unverified results, exaggerated before/after claims or false urgency.

Copy and message scripts

Plain language usually beats vague hype.

Copy formula: situation → offer → proof → action

ILLUSTRATIVE LOCAL SERVICE AD

“Planning a home solar installation in Surat? See the equipment and installation process, ask for a site assessment, and get a written proposal based on your roof and usage. Message us to discuss the next step.” Verify each claim before use.

Three copy starts to adapt

- Specific question: “What should you check before choosing [service]?” Show the checklist, then invite an enquiry.
- Process: “Here is how [product/service] works.” Show real steps and transparent conditions.
- Comparison: “Choosing between [option A] and [option B]?” Explain the deciding factors.

WhatsApp opening reply

“Hi, thanks for contacting [business]. To guide you properly, may I know your area and what you are looking for? I can share the options and next steps.”

Avoid wording that assumes sensitive personal attributes. Read the current Advertising Standards before publishing.

FIELD GUIDE / 12

Instant forms and WhatsApp

Choose the destination your team can handle well.

PATH	WORKS WELL WHEN	QUALITY CONTROL
Instant form	You need structured contact details without a website	Ask only necessary qualifying questions; include a privacy policy; follow up quickly
Click to WhatsApp	A conversation is useful to understand requirements	Use a clear opening prompt, trained responder and lead log
Website	The page and measurement are ready	Test mobile speed, relevant content and event tracking

Form question set: class enquiry (illustrative)

Name, preferred contact, locality, preferred batch time and the specific course of interest. Put the next step on the thank-you screen. Avoid asking for information you cannot use responsibly.

QUALITY METRIC

Qualified lead rate = qualified enquiries ÷ total enquiries. If 5 of 20 enquiries match your stated criteria, the illustrative rate is 25%. That number describes this hypothetical example only.

FIELD GUIDE / 13

Launch quality check

Use this checklist immediately before publication.

- ☐ **Goal** Objective, destination and performance goal align with the real business outcome.
- ☐ **Operations** Page/Instagram/WhatsApp identity, access, payment and response owner are ready.
- ☐ **Offer** Creative is truthful; price, location, availability and conditions are accurate.
- ☐ **Destination** Form or mobile page works; WhatsApp reaches the right number; privacy link works.
- ☐ **Creative** Feed, Story and Reel previews are legible; CTA and destination match.
- ☐ **Measurement** UTM naming, event test or lead log is ready; test cap and review date are written down.
- ☐ **Policy** Special ad category and Meta Advertising Standards have been checked.

AFTER PUBLISHING

A submitted campaign may be reviewed. If rejected, read the reason, correct the ad or landing page, and request another review where available. Do not repeatedly republish the same uncorrected issue.

FIELD GUIDE / 14

Read the numbers

Metrics answer different questions. Choose the one tied to your goal.

METRIC	PLAIN MEANING	USE IT TO ASK
Reach / impressions	People reached / times shown	Did delivery happen, and how often?
CTR (link)	Link clicks ÷ impressions	Did the ad invite action?
CPC (link)	Spend ÷ link clicks	How costly were link clicks?
CPM	Spend per 1,000 impressions	What did exposure cost?
Cost per result	Spend ÷ recorded results	What did the selected action cost?
Qualified lead rate	Qualified leads ÷ enquiries	Were the enquiries useful?

A “result” changes with the chosen objective and performance goal. Check the exact column definition, attribution setting and date range. Do not compare a cost per message to a cost per purchase as if they represent the same outcome.

ILLUSTRATIVE CALCULATION

Spend ₹1,200; 24 link clicks; 6 enquiries; 2 qualified. Link CPC = ₹50; cost per enquiry = ₹200; cost per qualified enquiry = ₹600. These are made-up numbers for arithmetic practice, not expected results.

FIELD GUIDE / 15

Diagnose weak results

Find the broken step before changing the whole campaign.

OBSERVATION	FIRST CHECK	SENSIBLE NEXT TEST
Little/no delivery	Status, billing, review, schedule, audience or bid controls	Resolve the operational blocker
Many impressions, few clicks	Creative, message, offer, CTA	New hook or clearer offer
Clicks, few enquiries	Page speed, relevance, form friction, broken links	Test destination on phone
Many enquiries, weak quality	Ad promise, qualification, geography	Clarify offer and add useful question
Qualified leads, few sales	Response time, sales script, pricing and follow-up	Improve handoff and track reasons

Do not chase a universal “good CTR” or “good CPC.” Compare against your own objective, location, offer, margin and previous tests. Very small samples can swing dramatically.

FIELD GUIDE / 16

Improve without guessing

Change one meaningful variable, then write down what happened.

The weekly review loop

Observe. Record spend, selected result, qualified outcomes and delivery status over a consistent date range.

Explain. Write one hypothesis: “People click, but the page does not show course timings.”

Change. Make one focused edit: add timetable and test the mobile page.

Compare. Review the same quality measure after enough delivery; note other changes and seasonality.

AVOID CONSTANT EDITS

Changing audience, creative, budget and destination together makes the result hard to interpret. Some changes can affect delivery learning. Keep a change log and let a useful test collect evidence.

If spend rises without meaningful outcomes, pause and inspect the full path. Scaling a weak funnel magnifies the problem.

FIELD GUIDE / 17

Illustrative campaign walkthrough

An example of reasoning, not a real case study or result forecast.

Scenario: A Surat training centre offers offline beginner sewing classes. The business wants qualified enquiries for the next batch and can respond during office hours. All details here are hypothetical.

DECISION	ILLUSTRATIVE CHOICE
Goal	Qualified enquiries that match locality and available batch
Objective/destination	Leads with an instant form, if available in the account
Audience	People in the actual catchment area; language matched to creative
Creative	Show the classroom and explain duration, schedule and next step
Form	Locality, preferred timing and contact information; privacy link
Operations	Lead owner calls or messages and marks qualification in a sheet
Review	Compare cost per qualified enquiry and reasons for rejection

WHAT THE EXAMPLE TEACHES

A cheap form submission is not the final answer. If the timing does not fit most people, put batch timings in the ad and form before changing audience targeting.

Copy-paste worksheets

Complete these before your first paid test.

Campaign brief

Business / offer: _____

Primary action / destination: _____

Service area and language: _____

Who handles enquiries and when: _____

Total affordable test cap / review date: _____

Qualified result means: _____

Change log

DATE	WHAT CHANGED	WHY	RESULT AFTER REVIEW
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

Ad copy worksheet

Customer situation: _____ | Offer details: _____ | Real proof: _____ | One action: _____

FIELD GUIDE / 19

30-day action plan

A guided first test with time to repair the whole customer path.

DAYS	WORK	OUTPUT
1-4	Define one offer, one desired action and qualification rules	One-page campaign brief
5-8	Check account access, billing, destination and lead owner	Working end-to-end path
9-12	Create two distinct creatives and copy versions; preview placements	Ready-to-publish assets
13-16	Build and publish a capped test; log daily delivery and enquiries	First observations
17-21	Audit lead quality and destination friction; choose one improvement	One written hypothesis
22-26	Run the focused change and compare with the original period	Decision note
27-30	Summarise spend, qualified outcomes, lost reasons and next test	One-page report and next brief

If the campaign has too little data by day 16, extend the observation window only if the test cap allows it. Time on the calendar is not evidence of performance.

Quick reference and sources

Keep these pages open when setting up and reviewing a campaign.

Five questions before every edit

1. What outcome am I optimising for? 2. Which step is weak? 3. What evidence supports that? 4. What single change will test the explanation? 5. When and how will I review it?

Sources & further reading — official Meta resources

Ads Manager overview · <https://www.facebook.com/business/help/200000840044554>

Campaign, ad set and ad levels · <https://www.facebook.com/business/help/621956575422138>

Choose an objective · <https://www.facebook.com/business/help/1438417719786914>

Create Instagram ads in Ads Manager ·

<https://www.facebook.com/business/help/1513393428972189>

Instant forms · <https://www.facebook.com/business/help/761812391313386>

Click-to-WhatsApp ads · <https://www.facebook.com/business/help/447934475640650>

Placements · <https://www.facebook.com/business/help/407108559393196>

Ads reporting · <https://www.facebook.com/business/help/318580098318734>

Advertising Standards · <https://transparency.meta.com/policies/ad-standards/>

Personal attributes policy · <https://transparency.meta.com/policies/ad-standards/objectionable-content/privacy-violations-personal-attributes/>

Source pages and interface labels can change. Check the linked guidance when you launch.

FIELD GUIDE / 21

Build, measure, improve.

The next campaign should be clearer than the last one.

You now have the working pieces: a specific offer, a goal that matches the desired action, a destination that works, creative that explains the offer, and a log that connects ad results to actual business outcomes.

YOUR NEXT MOVE

Complete the campaign brief on page 20. Test the full enquiry or checkout path yourself. Then launch one affordable, focused campaign and review the quality of the outcome.

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Learn Today. Earn Tomorrow.

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